

A scenic view of a coastal town, likely Mandurah, Australia. The foreground shows a sandy beach with gentle waves lapping at the shore. In the middle ground, a row of colorful, multi-story houses with balconies and gabled roofs sits on a slight rise. The background is a vast, overcast sky with soft, grey clouds. The overall color palette is muted, with blues, greys, and earthy tones.

CITY RELOCATION GUIDE • AUSTRALIA

Mandurah

Where you would work, where you would live, and what an ordinary week looks like in Mandurah.

Ethicare Resourcing

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This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Welcome to Mandurah

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Mandurah is a city built around water — an estuary twice the size of Sydney Harbour, a network of canals, and a long ocean coast — sitting under an hour south of Perth. For years it was where Perth went to holiday or retire. That is changing fast, and it is worth understanding why before you decide.

Mandurah in numbers

~90,000

people in Greater Mandurah, and among the fastest growth of any Western Australian city.

~50 min

to central Perth on the Mandurah line, and a similar drive on the freeway.

2×

the size of Sydney Harbour — the Peel-Harvey estuary the city sits on.

~72 km

south of the Perth CBD, at the northern end of the South West.

Two coasts

the sheltered estuary on one side, the open Indian Ocean on the other.

Year-round

a Mediterranean climate — hot dry summers, mild wet winters.

Six things nobody tells you

Before you decide

The “retirement town” label is out of date — the growth now is young families and commuters.

Summer is genuinely hot and dry; the estuary and the sea breeze are what make it comfortable.

Complex and subspecialty care is in Perth. Day-to-day work is here; the tertiary centre is an hour north.

The train changed the city. A Perth job while living on the coast is a real option, not a fantasy.

Crabbing is a genuine institution here, not a tourist gimmick — the estuary is full of blue swimmers.

Which water you live near — canal, estuary or ocean — shapes your budget and commute more than the suburb name.

In one line

A fast-growing waterside city under an hour from Perth, cheaper than the capital and built for an outdoor life — as long as you are clear-eyed that the big-hospital work is up the road, not on the doorstep.

Why Mandurah

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Mandurah earns a look for a specific kind of move: coast and space at a lower cost than Perth, with the capital still close enough to use. It is not for everyone, and the honest trade-offs matter as much as the appeal.

The case for Mandurah

The draw is a genuine waterside life — estuary, canals and ocean — at a price Perth's coastal suburbs no longer offer. The city is growing, so housing and services are being built rather than stretched, and the family estates north and south are among the more affordable new housing within reach of a capital.

For work, the Peel region carries a real community and outpatient caseload, and private imaging has a steady presence. And because the train reaches central Perth in under an hour, a role in the city while living on the coast is a legitimate plan rather than a stretch.

What you give up

The trade is clinical breadth. The complex, high-acuity and subspecialty work concentrates in Perth's tertiary hospitals, so if that is the centre of your career, Mandurah is a base near it rather than a substitute for it. You also take on a hot, dry summer, a car-dependent everyday outside the rail corridor, and a city still growing into itself — some services and culture are thinner than a capital's.

Mandurah suits you if...

You want the coast and the estuary without a Perth coastal-suburb price.

Your work is community, outpatient or imaging-based — or you are happy to commute to Perth for it.

You are moving with family and want space, newer housing and the outdoors close by.

You value a slower, water-centred life over the density and options of a capital.

The honest version

Mandurah trades clinical breadth for space, coast and cost. If Perth is close enough to use when you need it, that can be a very good trade.

Mandurah at a glance

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Mandurah makes sense once you see it is built around an estuary, not a high street. Where people live, which water they use and how long anything takes all follow from that.

The shape of the place

The city wraps the mouth of the Peel-Harvey estuary, one of the largest in the country, where the Serpentine and Murray rivers meet the sea. Canals thread the newer suburbs, an artificial channel — the Dawesville Cut — flushes the estuary to the ocean, and a long dune coast runs south. The centre and its marina sit on the water; the suburbs spread north and south along both the estuary and the coast.

In practice, your side of the water sets your life: canal or estuary for flat water and boats, the ocean side for surf and beaches, the rail corridor for the Perth commute.

~72 km

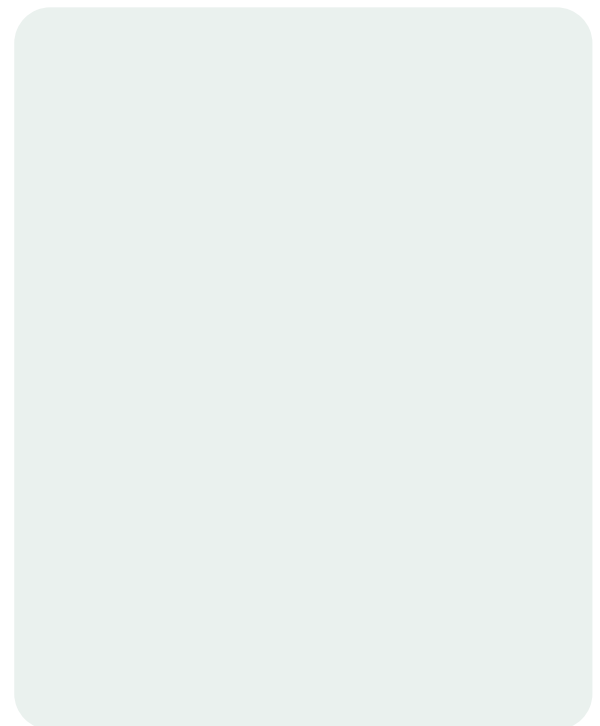
South of Perth

~90,000

Greater Mandurah

2×

Sydney Harbour — the estuary



Where Mandurah sits, with the straight-line distance to Perth and Bunbury

The seasons, honestly

This is a Mediterranean climate, close to Perth's: long hot dry summers and mild, genuinely wet winters. The estuary and the reliable afternoon sea breeze — the local "Fremantle Doctor" — are what take the edge off January.

Summer — Dec to Feb

Hot and dry, often well into the 30s, cooled most afternoons by the sea breeze.

Autumn — Mar to May

The best of it: warm water, settled days and the crowds gone.

Winter — Jun to Aug

Mild and wet, with storms off the Indian Ocean. Cool, not cold.

Spring — Sep to Nov

Wildflowers inland and the first swimmable days by the end of it.

How the city got here

Long before

Bindjareb Noongar country

The estuary is Bindjareb country, part of the wider Noongar nation of the south-west, lived on and fished for tens of thousands of years. Pinjarra, inland, carries a difficult and important history the region does not hide.

19th century

An estuary settlement

European settlement followed the fishing and the sheltered water. For a long time Mandurah stayed small — a crabbing and holiday place more than a city.

1990s

The Cut, and the canals

The Dawesville Cut opened to flush the estuary, and canal estates reshaped the waterfront. Mandurah began to grow in earnest.

2007 onward

The railway, and a real city

The Perth-to-Mandurah line put the CBD under an hour away, the population climbed, and the holiday town became somewhere to live.

Orientation, in one line

A city on one of the country's biggest estuaries, an hour south of Perth, warm and coastal and still growing. Decide which water you want to live near, and the rest of the map follows.

Healthcare in Mandurah

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Mandurah gives you a regional healthcare base with Perth's tertiary system close enough to lean on. What that means for your week depends a lot on your profession and where the work actually sits.

The local picture

The Peel region is served by a health campus combining public and private services, alongside community and primary care and a steady private imaging presence across the city. It handles the general and outpatient load of a growing population. What it does not do is the most complex, high-acuity and subspecialty work — that concentrates in Perth's tertiary hospitals, under an hour north, and referrals move up the line for it.

For medical imaging — the area we currently recruit into in Western Australia — that usually means a broad general caseload locally, with the subspecialty and interventional work weighted towards the city.

What to ask before you sign

The title tells you less than the setting. Before you commit, get clear on the modality mix and equipment, the on-call and rostering, the supervision and development available, and how much of the interesting work stays local versus travelling to Perth. A role that looks the same on paper can be a very different week here than in a capital.

Registration, in short

You will need Ahpra registration through your profession's National Board before you can practise.

Medical radiation professionals also need a Western Australian radiation use licence — a state requirement on top of registration.

Both are set out in full, with official sources, in the national [eligibility & registration](#) guide, and the [pathway checker](#) shows the likely route for your profession.

In one line

A solid regional and community base with the tertiary system an hour away. Ask what stays local and what travels to Perth — that answer shapes the job more than the location does.

Where clinicians live

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The first decision in Mandurah is not which suburb — it is which water, and how far from the train. Everything else follows from that.

The three kinds of place

Canal and estuary. Halls Head, Erskine and Dudley Park put you on flat water, sometimes with a mooring at the door. This is the premium end, and the closest thing to the postcard, but you pay for the frontage.

The newer family estates. Madora Bay, Lakelands and Dawesville are where much of the growth — and the more affordable new housing — has gone: bigger blocks, newer schools, a longer run into the centre.

Central and the coast. Around the foreshore and the older beachside pockets you trade some space for walkability, the marina and the train.

The decision to make first

Rank three things in your own order: which water (and how close), value for space, and closeness to the Mandurah line if Perth is part of your plan. It is hard to have all three, and being honest about the ranking is what stops you renting or buying in the wrong half of the city.

On the water

Halls Head, Erskine, Dudley Park — canal and estuary frontage, at a premium.

Space and value

Madora Bay, Lakelands, Dawesville — newer estates, more house for the money.

Walk and commute

Central and foreshore — near the marina, cafes and the train.

One rule

Pick your water and your commute first; the suburb name matters far less.

In one line

Canal, coast or commuter belt — Mandurah is really three choices. Rank water, value and the train honestly, and the shortlist writes itself.

Getting around

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Mandurah is a car city with one significant exception: the railway that reaches central Perth in under an hour. How much you use each one shapes where you should live.

The Mandurah line

The train runs from the city centre to the Perth CBD in around fifty minutes, with park-and-ride at the stations along the corridor. It is what makes a Perth job while living on the coast realistic — and the single biggest reason to weight your suburb search towards the rail corridor if the capital is part of your plan.

Roads and the everyday

Off the rail line, Mandurah runs on cars. The Kwinana Freeway and Forrest Highway carry you north to Perth and south into the South West, and getting around town is a fifteen-to-twenty-minute affair rather than a commute. The rebuilt foreshore and marina are genuinely walkable; most of the rest of the city is not, which is worth planning for if you would rather not run two cars.

Mandurah → Perth CBD

About 50 minutes by train, or a similar drive outside peak.

Across town

Typically 15–20 minutes by car; traffic is not a daily event.

South West

Bunbury about an hour further south on the highway.

The car question

One car works on the rail corridor; two is the norm in the outer estates.

In one line

A car city with a fast train to the capital. If you will use Perth often, live near the line; if not, the coast opens up.

Cost of living

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Mandurah generally costs less to live in than Perth's coastal suburbs — that is much of the point — with a couple of things that quietly cost more. We do not print dollar figures we have not verified; the tools below build a real budget.

What costs less, the same, and more

Housing is the headline: for the same money you are generally closer to the water here than in equivalent Perth suburbs, and the newer estates offer more house again. Groceries, services and the everyday sit broadly where they do across the Perth region. Two things run the other way — keeping a house cool through a long hot summer, and the cost of distance: fuel and time if you commute to Perth, and pricier flights home from a regional base.

Housing Generally less than coastal Perth

Everyday Broadly similar to Perth

Cooling & distance The two that cost more

Budget it properly

Set-up costs, rent in advance and bond, the flights and the first months all add up, and they are the same wherever in Australia you land. Build the number with the [moving-cost calculator](#), and read how tax, superannuation and the Medicare levy work in the national [money, tax & banking](#) guide before you commit to anything.

In one line

Cheaper than coastal Perth, especially on housing — just budget honestly for summer cooling and the cost of the distance.

Food, the water & the everyday

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In Mandurah the estuary sets the table. The water is not just scenery here — it is where a lot of the food, and the weekends, come from.

Crabbing and the catch

The Peel estuary is famous for its blue swimmer crabs, and crabbing — by scoop or drop net, to the local size and bag rules — is a genuine institution rather than a novelty. The city throws a festival for it each year. Fresh seafood, the marina's fish and chips, and waterfront cafes and restaurants along the rebuilt foreshore round it out.

The ordinary week

Beyond the water, an ordinary week looks like markets and coffee on the foreshore, kids' sport, and the beach or the estuary after work while the light lasts. It is an outdoors-first, unhurried rhythm — part of the appeal, and part of what people mean when they say it is quieter than a capital.

In one line

Crabs, the marina and the foreshore — the estuary is the centre of the everyday. If a water-centred, outdoors week is what you are after, this is the draw.

Dwellingup, Yalgorup & the weekend

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From Mandurah the weekend goes three ways: jarrah forest inland, a national park and beaches to the south, and Perth and Fremantle an easy hour north.

Inland — the jarrah forest

Dwellingup, about forty minutes into the hills, is the gateway to the northern jarrah forest and a hub for the Munda Biddi cycle trail and the Bibbulmun walking track, with mountain biking, whitewater on the Murray and cool green forest that feels a world away from the coast. It is the classic Mandurah escape when summer gets serious.

Coast, park and city

South, Yalgorup National Park holds quiet beaches and the thrombolites at Lake Clifton — living rock structures among the oldest records of life on earth. North, Perth and Fremantle are close enough for a spontaneous day: markets, the port city's cafes and bars, galleries and the things a capital does that a coastal city does not.

In one line

Forest one way, a national park the other, the capital an hour north. Mandurah's weekends are wider than the city itself.